

JINGNONG QU

Seattle, WA

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EDUCATION

University of Washington

September 2024-Present

Ph.D. in Linguistics (Computational Track)

University of California, Los Angeles

September 2022-June 2024

M.S. in Computer Science

University of California, Los Angeles

August 2018-June 2022

B.S. in Computer Science

Summa Cum Laude

B.A. in Linguistics & Computer Science

Summa Cum Laude

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Computation, Language, and Meaning Band of Researchers

September 2024-Present

Researcher

Group led by Professor Shane Steinert-Threlkeld

- Implemented Metropolis-Hastings sampling for the Unnatural Language ToolKit (ULTK)
- Analyzed the effectiveness of Brain Score by training Transformer-based language models on various sequences
- Conducted research in the mechanistic interpretability of models trained on filtered corpora

UCLA NLP

April 2021-June 2024

Researcher

Group led by Professor Kai-Wei Chang

- Conducted research in classification of multi-modal internet memes using state-of-the-art NLP models
- Devised data augmentation methods for summary evaluation using Abstract Meaning Representation (AMR)
- Utilized platforms including Google Cloud, AWS, and Amazon MTurk

EMPLOYMENT

Research Assistant

- Literature review on the evaluation of language models (under Professor Fei Xia) Autumn 2024
- Maintenance of tools for publishing data of Native American languages (under Professor Sharon Hargus) Autumn 2024, Winter 2026, Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

- Introduction to Study of Language (LING 1) Spring 2022
- Introduction to Linguistic Analysis (LING 20) Winter 2024
- Semantics I (LING 120C) Spring 2024
- Introduction to Linguistics (LING 200) Winter 2025, Spring 2025
- Introduction to Syntax for Computational Linguistics (LING 566) Autumn 2025

SKILLS

Programming languages

Python, C/C++, Java, Javascript, MariaDB, Haskell, OCaml, Lisp

Natural languages

Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), German (Elementary), French (Elementary)

Tools

PyTorch, Pandas, Git, Docker, AWS, Google Cloud, MTurk, L^AT_EX, Praat

PUBLICATION

- Jingnong Qu, Ashvin Ranjan, and Shane Steinert-Threlkeld. 2026. Brain score tracks shared properties of languages: Evidence from many natural languages and structured sequences. Under review at *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*

- Christopher Haberland*, Carly Crowther*, Jingnong Qu, and Anuk Centellas. 2026. Bridging digital tools for linguistic documentation and revitalization. In *Proceedings of the Sixth Workshop on NLP for Indigenous Languages of the Americas (AmericasNLP)*, pages 22–32, San Diego, California, USA. Association for Computational Linguistics
- Haoyi Qiu, Kung-Hsiang Huang*, Jingnong Qu*, and Nanyun Peng. 2024. AMRFact: Enhancing summarization factuality evaluation with AMR-driven negative samples generation. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 594–608, Mexico City, Mexico. Association for Computational Linguistics
- Jingnong Qu, Liunian Harold Li, Jieyu Zhao, Sunipa Dev, and Kai-Wei Chang. 2022. DisinfoMeme: A multimodal dataset for detecting meme intentionally spreading out disinformation. ArXiv preprint arXiv:2205.12617

**Equal contribution*